



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	High Visibility Clothing				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Construction Safety and Visibility

If vehicle safety practices are not observed at your site, you risk being pinned between construction vehicles and walls, struck by swinging backhoes, crushed beneath overturned vehicles or being struck by plant or traffic. This toolbox talk *is not intended* to discuss vehicle/equipment safe practices but *is intended* to be information regarding worker visibility:

Workers need to be seen during poor lighting or weather conditions, or when working in environments where there are a lot of moving vehicles or equipment.

All workers should wear high visibility apparel. Garments must be reflective.

Workers must be highly visible in all levels of light.

Worker visibility during dawn or dusk conditions may be enhanced by the use of fluorescent coloured high visibility apparel.

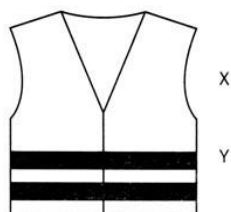
The use of colours such as yellow/green for the worker apparel may help to differentiate the worker from the orange-coloured work vehicles, signs, drums, etc.

Banksman should always wear high visibility vests.

Workers responsible for temporary traffic control should be adequately trained.

High-visibility safety clothing should be replaced when it becomes faded, torn, dirty, soiled, worn, or defaced, or if it is not visible at 300 metres day or night.

High visibility clothing should be manufactured to a recognised standard. The British Standard for high visibility warning clothing is BS EN 471. This is a harmonised European standard produced with the legal requirements for PPE in mind. Clothing which conforms to the standard is marked with a pictogram like this:



The first number (X) indicates the class of conspicuity, this depends on the minimum area of conspicuous materials that are incorporated into the clothing, with Class 3 being the best and Class 1 the lowest; the second number (Y) indicates the retro-reflection performance with Class 2 being more visible than Class 1 when seen in headlights during darkness. The standard gives specifications for coveralls, jackets, waistcoats, tabards, trousers and harnesses.

New clothing must be 'UKCA' or 'EUCE' marked to show it meets the rules on the manufacture of PPE.

Remember: the CA/CE mark only means that the clothing meets the standard. It does not mean it can be used in all situations. High-visibility clothing must be suitable for the actual conditions of use.

**Discussion Points**

Is your High Visibility Clothing in good state of repair?

When and where are high visibility clothing supposed to be worn here?